with similar accord and knowledge do decree, that to copies of them, signed by the hand of a public notary commissioned therefor, and sealed with the seal of any ecclesiastical officer or ecclesiastical court, the same respect is to be shown in court and outside as well as anywhere else as would be given to these presents should they thus be exhibited or shown. Let no one, therefore, infringe, or with rash boldness contravene, this our recommendation, exhortation, requisition, gift, grant, assignment, constitution, deputation, decree, mandate, prohibition, and will. Should anyone presume to attempt this, be it known to him that he will incur the wrath of Almighty God and of the blessed apostles Peter and Paul. Given at Rome, at St. Peter's, in the year of the incarnation of our Lord one thousand four hundred and ninety-three, the fourth of May, and the first year of our pontificate.

Gratis by order of our most holy lord, the pope.

Alexander

May 4, 1493[15] [emphases added]

The Christian command to convert non-Christians could not have been more explicit. Importantly, the reference to India in the Bull was of direct consequence to the European colonisation of Bharat as we shall see later in Chapter 8. While the Bull was issued after Columbus' expedition of 1492, as is evident from the Bull, Christian injunctions undergirded both the expedition and the subsequent voyages to the New World. According to Wynter, the treatment of 'pagan polytheistic peoples' as 'idolators' by Columbus was traceable to the Judeo-Christian perception of the world's population being divided into:

1. Christians (who had heard and accepted the new Word of the gospel),
2. infidels like the Muslims and Jews, who, although they were monotheists, had refused the Word, and
3. those pagan polytheistic peoples who had either ignored or had not yet been preached the Word.

Wynter was of the view that the religious term 'idolator' informed the meaning of secular terms, such as 'Indios' or 'Indians', which led to the religion-induced racial othering of non-Christian idol-worshipping communities encountered by Columbus. The encounter of the Christian